Jailbreaks and guardrails

AI security · Lower secondary · Lesson 4



In this lesson you will

- Explain why chatbots refuse some requests, and why rewording can slip past.
- Compare word filters with a check on the action in code.
- Know what to do when a chatbot gives you something harmful.

Remember

- Refusals are learned, so new wordings can slip past.
- Word filters miss rewording; a check on the action holds.
- Harmful answer? Stop, don't share, report, tell an adult.

Activity: The word-list robot

1. Set up (3 min): Pick a robot and five banned words.
2. Round 1 (6 min): Reword pretend spam to get past the list.
3. Round 2 (6 min): Add the rule “only if the owner said yes”.
4. Share (5 min): Compare the tallies. Which rule held?

Keep every message harmless and made up: sweets, football, school trips. The game is about the rules, not about getting anyone to say something bad.

Let’s discuss

1. Why can't a chatbot's training stop every jailbreak?
2. Why does a check on the action work, whatever the wording?
3. Why is reporting a gap better than showing it off?

Check yourself

- Name one guardrail that rewording can beat and one that it can't, and say why.